

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5 2
 ♥ 10 7 4
 ♦ A Q 10 6 3
 ♣ Q 10

♠ A K 7 4
 ♥ K Q 9 6
 ♦ J 8
 ♣ 9 7 6



♠ Q 3
 ♥ A J 3 2
 ♦ K 9 5
 ♣ J 5 4 2

♠ J 10 9 6
 ♥ 8 5
 ♦ 7 4 2
 ♣ A K 8 3

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠		
All Pass			
2 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♠ 2			

You have plenty good support to raise partner's ♣ suit. But your first priority is to show a 4-card Major suit if you have one. You do, so you respond 1 ♠. Partner raises you to 2 ♠.

Are you tempted to take partner back to ♣s since you have such good support? Don't be. Partner has 4 ♠s, but he might have only 3 ♣s.

Are you tempted to bid 3 ♠ since partner raised you? Don't be. He showed a minimum hand with his single raise and you only have 9 points. Just pass.

Board 2

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 8 5

♥ 7

♦ J 6 5

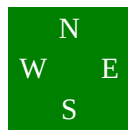
♣ K Q 9 7 4

♠ A K 9

♥ K Q 8 3

♦ Q 10 4 2

♣ 10 3



♠ 10 4 3 2

♥ 10 5 4 2

♦ 9 7

♣ A 6 2

♠ 7 6

♥ A J 9 6

♦ A K 8 3

♣ J 8 5

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

Lead: ♣K

Some might jump to 2NT, "to show partner my point count". Some might jump to 3 ♦, "to force partner to game and show my ♦ support". The wise ones will just bid 1 ♥, striving to find an 8-card Major fit, the first priority of bidding.

You choose the 1 ♥ route, and partner obligingly says 2 ♥.

Remember "She who knows, goes"? You know of the 8-card Major fit. You know of at least 26 combined points. You know you should bid 4 ♥, so you do.

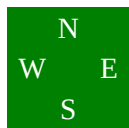
Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 8
 ♥ J 10 6 3 2
 ♦ A 8 5
 ♣ 8 4 3 2

♠ Q J 10 7
 ♥ K Q 9 8
 ♦ 7 6 2
 ♣ K Q



♠ A 5 4 2
 ♥ 5 4
 ♦ K Q 4 3
 ♣ 9 6 5

♠ K 9 6 3
 ♥ A 7
 ♦ J 10 9
 ♣ A J 10 7

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1 ♣
Pass	1 ♥	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			
Lead: ♣ 3			

When you have two 4-card suits to show you bid them "up-the-line". In this case it means you say 1 ♥. Partner replies 1 ♠.

There are enough points for game and a known 8-card Major fit. So you bid 4 ♠.

Perfect bidding isn't always rewarded. They can win three ♦ tricks and the Ace of trumps. If the opening lead is a ♥ or a ♣ you might make it, so it just depends on luck.

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

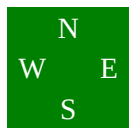
♠ 9 8 7 3
 ♥ A 8 5 3
 ♦ J 10 5
 ♣ 4 2

♠ K 10 4

♥ J 9 7

♦ A K 7 2

♣ K 5 3



♠ Q 6 2

♥ Q 4 2

♦ 4 3

♣ Q J 10 8 7

♠ A J 5

♥ K 10 6

♦ Q 9 8 6

♣ A 9 6

*West**North**East**South*

1♦

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♠8

You have two very good choices, neither of which is really wrong. You could bid 2NT, showing 13-16 points, balanced, or you could bid 3♦, showing 13-16 points, good trump support.

What should decide you is the bidding priorities. You'd much rather try to play a 9-trick game than an 11-trick game. And at the same time you must trust your partner not to leave you hung out in Notrump with an unsuitable hand. (Can you believe I wrote Notrump and unsuitable in the same sentence?)

Anyway, you bid 2NT and partner raises to 3NT.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

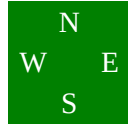
♠ Q 6
 ♥ A 8
 ♦ 10 9 8 5 4
 ♣ 10 9 7 4

♠ A K 9 2

♥ J 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ K 8 3 2



♠ J 7 5 4
 ♥ 9 7 4 3 2
 ♦ J 3
 ♣ A 6

♠ 10 8 3

♥ K Q 10 6

♦ A Q 6

♣ Q J 5

West	North	East	South
	1 ♣	Pass	1 ♥
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 9			

With 14 points and a 4-3-3-3 distribution this could be the perfect hand for a jump to 2NT. But not when the 4-card suit is a Major - you should not skip bidding a Major when you have the opportunity.

So you respond 1 ♥. Partner says 1 ♠.

Partner doesn't have 4 ♥s so you go back to thinking this is an ideal notrump hand. So ideal that you apply the "She who knows, goes" principle and bid 3NT. Partner smiles and passes.